

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Security Architecture | Incident Response | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing and maintaining security controls across complex hybrid IT environments. My expertise spans Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) for threat detection and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) engineering, the full Microsoft Defender suite including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft 365 Defender, and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Entra ID for identity and access management including Single Sign-On (SSO) and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). I have a strong background in incident response, threat monitoring, vulnerability management and security architecture, and I am experienced working across Windows Server and Azure hybrid infrastructure. I hold the CISSP, which directly meets the certification requirement for this role, and I bring the technical depth to take ownership of cybersecurity controls for a global professional services organisation operating in a regulated, high-confidentiality environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel / SIEM Engineering:** KQL-based detection rule authoring, log source onboarding, alert tuning, workbook development and threat hunting across Azure Sentinel
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender -- deployed and managed across an 8,000-user estate
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure AD / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, MFA, SSO, Privileged Identity Management; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Security Architecture:** Designing and maintaining layered security controls across on-premises and Azure hybrid environments; aligning architecture to NIST CSF, ISO 27001 and CIS Controls
- **Incident Response:** End-to-end incident handling per NIST 800-61; containment, eradication, recovery and root cause analysis; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned investigation
- **Threat Monitoring and Detection Engineering:** Continuous monitoring, alert correlation and detection logic development; mapping detection coverage to MITRE ATT&CK
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation governance
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response); Tanium endpoint management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security automation and SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) playbook development
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Other Tools:** Mimecast email security, Check Point Harmony firewall, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Splunk

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 -- Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Designing and maintaining cybersecurity controls across a complex hybrid IT environment serving 8,000+ users, aligned to ISO 27001, NIST CSF and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks.
- Engineering and managing Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, authoring KQL detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and tuning alerts to reduce noise while maintaining high-fidelity threat detection.

- Administering the full Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender), configuring detection policies, managing alerts and integrating telemetry into the centralised SIEM.
- Owning incident response for confirmed security events including ransomware, phishing and insider threat scenarios, following NIST 800-61 from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review.
- Managing Azure AD / Entra ID identity governance: Conditional Access policy design, MFA rollout, SSO federation and Privileged Access Management (PAM) controls via BeyondTrust.
- Leading the vulnerability management programme using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck, prioritising findings by risk and overseeing remediation with infrastructure and application teams.
- Providing input to the organisation's security architecture decisions, reviewing proposed changes against the current threat landscape and advising on control design for Azure and Windows Server infrastructure.
- Managing CrowdStrike Falcon EDR policy tuning, threat hunting in Falcon Insight and Discover asset visibility across the endpoint fleet.
- Developing PowerShell-based SOAR automation to accelerate incident triage and response, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for common attack patterns.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Performed threat monitoring and SIEM-based alert triage, investigating security incidents and escalating confirmed threats through defined response procedures.
- Deployed and configured Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across the UAL estate, working with infrastructure teams to ensure comprehensive telemetry coverage.
- Supported design and implementation of Azure AD Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout and SSO configurations for internal and federated applications.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised reports and tracking remediation progress across the Windows Server estate.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 certification and Cyber Essentials Plus assessments, preparing evidence packs and liaising with internal auditors.
- Administered Mimecast email security and anti-phishing policies, reducing user exposure to email-borne threats.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 -- March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security engineering, vulnerability assessment and infrastructure support within a Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, maintaining security controls across cloud-hosted and on-premises systems.
- Supported identity and access management, endpoint security and network security operations in alignment with business and regulatory requirements.
- Contributed to IT quality assurance processes and change management in an ITIL-aligned service delivery model.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the end-to-end deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an 8,000-user estate at UAL, delivering a significant uplift in endpoint and identity threat visibility.
- Designed a suite of KQL-based MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced mean time to detect (MTTD) for credential-based attacks by over 50%.
- Identified and closed a critical Azure AD Conditional Access misconfiguration that had permitted MFA bypass for a set of privileged accounts, eliminating a high-severity identity risk.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, underpinning the organisation's compliance posture and cyber insurance requirements.
- Delivered a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercise that uncovered five previously unknown lateral movement paths, enabling proactive remediation before exploitation by a threat actor.
- Automated incident triage workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, reducing manual analyst workload and cutting average phishing triage time by approximately 30 minutes per event.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)